

# Modal Verbs · 情态动词

## 1. 最常见用法 Common Uses

CAN 能 / 会（能力、许可）

| English                                      | Chinese       |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|
| I can scan the code to pay.                  | 我能扫码付款。       |
| Can I sit here?                              | 我能坐这儿吗？       |
| I can't hear you — the subway is too loud.   | 我听不清——地铁太吵了。  |
| I can ride a shared bike, but I can't drive. | 我会骑共享单车，不会开车。 |

COULD 可以（更礼貌；过去的能力）

| English                                 | Chinese    |
|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| Could you say that again?               | 你能再说一遍吗？   |
| Could I use your charger?               | 我能借你的充电器吗？ |
| When I was in school, I could run 5 km. | 上学时我能跑五公里。 |

SHOULD 应该（建议、责任）

| English                                            | Chinese       |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| You should bring an umbrella — it's going to rain. | 你应该带把伞，要下雨了。  |
| I should reply to this message first.              | 我应该先回这条消息。    |
| You shouldn't work overtime every day.             | 你不该天天加班。      |
| We should split the bill evenly.                   | 我们应该 AA 平分账单。 |

MUST / HAVE TO 必须（强义务）

| English                                      | Chinese      |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------|
| You have to scan the code before you get on. | 上车前必须扫码。     |
| I have to take the last subway home.         | 我得赶末班地铁回家。   |
| I must pay the bill before 10 p.m.           | 我必须在晚上十点前付款。 |
| You don't have to tip in China.              | 在中国你不用给小费。   |
| You mustn't smoke here.                      | 这里禁止吸烟。      |

WILL / WOULD 将会 / 愿意

| English                          | Chinese   |
|----------------------------------|-----------|
| I will call you when I arrive.   | 到了我给你打电话。 |
| Would you like some tea?         | 要来点茶吗？    |
| Would you mind waiting a minute? | 你介意等一分钟吗？ |

## 2. 可能性推测 Possibility & Deduction

MAY / MIGHT / COULD 可能（不确定）

| English                                | Chinese     |
|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| It may rain this afternoon.            | 下午可能下雨。     |
| He might be stuck in traffic.          | 他可能堵在路上了。   |
| The delivery could arrive late.        | 外卖可能会晚到。    |
| She might not see the message.         | 她可能没看到消息。   |
| Ordering takeout on 美团 may be cheaper. | 美团点外卖可能更便宜。 |

MUST 一定（把握很大的肯定推测）

| English                                         | Chinese      |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| You've worked all day — you must be tired.      | 你忙了一整天，一定很累。 |
| The line is so long — the food must be good.    | 排这么长的队，一定好吃。 |
| Your phone is off — you must be out of battery. | 你关机了，一定没电了。  |

CAN'T 不可能（把握很大的否定推测）

| English                                  | Chinese        |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| That can't be true — I just saw him.     | 那不可能是真的，我刚见过他。 |
| It can't be 9 p.m. already.              | 不可能已经晚上九点了。    |
| She can't be at home — the light is off. | 她不可能在家，灯都灭了。   |

| 推测词   | 确定程度   | 例句                                              |
|-------|--------|-------------------------------------------------|
| might | 可能 50% | He <b>might</b> be stuck in traffic. 他可能堵在路上了。  |
| could | 也许 60% | The delivery <b>could</b> arrive late. 外卖可能会晚到。 |
| may   | 可能 70% | It <b>may</b> rain this afternoon. 下午可能下雨。      |
| must  | 一定 95% | You <b>must</b> be tired. 你一定很累。                |
| can't | 不可能    | That <b>can't</b> be true. 那不可能是真的。             |

### 3. Discussion 讨论

| English                                                      | Chinese             | Answer tags                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your QR payment fails. What should you do?                   | 扫码付款失败怎么办？          | Try WeChat Pay / Check the Wi-Fi / Ask the staff              |
| Your boss wants an AI report. What can AI do?                | 老板要 AI 写报告，AI 能做什么？ | Draft it / Check the facts / Don't copy it blindly            |
| Would you take a 萝卜快跑 taxi alone at night?                   | 你敢深夜独自坐萝卜快跑吗？       | Yes, I <b>would</b> / I <b>might</b> with a friend            |
| The retirement age is rising. What must you do now?          | 退休年龄推迟，你必须做什么？      | Save money / Stay healthy / Learn new skills                  |
| Delivery drones may come soon. What could go wrong?          | 无人机送外卖，可能出什么问题？     | They <b>might</b> be noisy / They <b>could</b> drop it        |
| Tickets go on sale at 10 a.m. What had you better do?        | 门票十点开抢，你最好先做什么？     | <b>Had better</b> test the app / <b>Should</b> add my ID      |
| Your friend buys every new phone. What should you say?       | 朋友总买最新款手机，你该说什么？    | You <b>don't have to</b> upgrade / Compare prices             |
| Your EV is low on battery. What mustn't you do?              | 电动车快没电了，绝对不能做什么？    | <b>Mustn't</b> wait / Plan charging stops / Use an app        |
| The 2026 World Cup is in North America. Would you?           | 世界杯在北美，你会熬夜看吗？      | I <b>might</b> watch the final / Not every game               |
| Your parents live alone. What should you do for them?        | 父母独自居住，你该为他们做什么？    | Call more / Visit monthly / Check their health app            |
| Hospitals now take 电子医保. What don't you have to do?          | 用电子医保后，哪些事不用做了？     | Carry the card / Fill out paper forms                         |
| Your colleague works every night. What would you rather say? | 同事天天加班，你宁愿说什么？      | Rest first / <b>Shouldn't</b> work every night                |
| House prices are uncertain. Would you rent or buy?           | 房价不确定，你会租房还是买房？     | I'd <b>rather</b> rent / I <b>would</b> buy if I <b>could</b> |